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EPP- II, 2024-25 GLA U, Mathura
Module-I(Verbal Skills)

Tenses

Tense in grammar locate action/ events in time usually through some verbal forms. Basically, tense denotes the characteristics of the verb in a sentence. There are three tenses:There are three tenses:

1. **Present Tense:** Expresses actions happening now or habitual actions.
2. **Past Tense:** Expresses actions that have already happened.
3. **Future Tense:** Expresses actions that will happen in the future.

Tense	Main Use	Example
Structure		
Present Simple	1- To talk about things in general, things that are happening all the time (and not particularly now) (We often use words like always , never, usually, generally, often, seldom, sometimes, everyday, on Sundays , once a month etc. with this tense)	1- We usually **spend** our evenings on the beach. 2- **Do** these shops **open** on Sunday? 1- I seldom **get** late for school. 2- My father generally **reads** The Hindu.
	2-To express scientific facts or permanent truth:	1-The first law of thermodynamics **states** that energy cannot be created or destroyed, only transformed from one form to another.
	3- To express natural qualities or processes and professional activities:	1-Parents **love** their children. 2-A botanist **studies** plants
	4-In newspaper headlines	1-Centre **says** it will accept SC decision on Dallewal strike
	5-To express a future event already planned	1-My flight **takes off** tomorrow morning at 6:30.
	6- In running commentaries	Rahul **hits** the ball towards the silly mid off.The ball **passes** over the fields head and **crosses** the boundary line.
	7- In proverbs which have the force of permanent truth	1- Too many cooks **spoil** the broth
	8- To talk about thoughts and feeling at the present moment	1- I **feel** drowsy. 2- Lakshay **is** awfully busy.
	-9 Routine behaviour	1-I **drink** coffee every morning. 2-She **goes** to the gym twice a week.
	10-Used in reviews: To discuss what happens in a book, play, or film.	1-In the film he **plays** the central character of Charles Smithson. 2-In those early chapters, he **keeps** himself very

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Tense	Main Use	Example
Structure		
Present Progressive	1-For an activity that is in progress at the time of speaking	1- We ***are playing*** *'Among us'*. Come and join in. 2- What ***am*** I ***doing***? I *am looking* out of the
	2-For an activity that is going on these days not necessarily at the moment of speaking	1- Suruchi is working as an anchor for Big Boss. 2- Sushant is preparing for the I.i.T entrance exan
	3- to express a definite programme in the near future (In these sentences an adverbial of future time is always mentioned to avoid confusion)	1- She **is giving** us treat tomorrow evening. 2- On Monday I **am leaving** for Chennai.
	4-To emphasise the present moment, or to indicate that a situation is temporary.	1-We **are trying** to create a more democratic society. 2-She **is spending** the winter vacations in Kerala.
	5-To talk about changes, trends, development, and progress.	1-His handwriting **is improving** by the day. 2-World energy demand **is increasing** at a rate of about 8% per year.
	6-To talk about a habitual action that takes place regularly, especially one that is new or temporary.	1-You **are going** out a lot these days. 2-Do you know if she **is** still **playing** these days?
	7- used with words like always and forever to emphasize how often the action takes place (It expresses disapproval or annoyance).	1-You ***are*** always **looking** for faults. 2-It **is** always **raining.**

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Structure		
Present Perfect	1-To express an action very recently completed	1-I **have** just **completed** my assignment. 2- The last bus has just left.
	2-To talk about an activity or situation that started at some time in the past, continued, just finishes at that moment	1-All my adult life I **have waited** for the emergence of a strong centre party. 2-She **has** always **felt** that films should be entertaining.
	3- To express an action which took place in the past but whose effect can be felt at the moment of speaking (this tense doesn't take past time adverbials like yesterday, last week, last month etc.)	1-The baby **has had** her milk. 2- I **have qualified** as a Judo instructor in 2004.X
	4-The expression like solar, up till now, for ,since, just, yet, already, often, always, ever, never, often, seldom may be used	Mrs. Mehra **has** always **done** her duty sincerely.

Tense	Main Use	Example
Present Perfect Continuous	1-For actions that started in the past is in progress at the time of speaking and will extend into the future (Since and for arecoften used with this tense since suggests the point of time at which an action started, for suggests period of timer which action is going on)	1-I **have been living** in this city for five years. (I still live here.) 2-She **has been working** at that company since 2015. (She still works there.) 3-I **have been waiting** here since 7'O clock.
	To emphasize the duration of a recent event Present perfect Continuous is used:.	1- She **has been crying** *for hours* 2-Some people will say that what I **have been describing** is not a crisis of industry.

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Tense	Main Use	Example
Structure		
Simple Past/Past Indefinite	1-To express completed actions at some point of time in the past: The time can be specified (e.g., yesterday, last week, in 2010) or implied (e.g., in my childhood, when I was in Paris).	1-She **joined** this university last month. 2- His explanation **impressed** everybody.
	2-To express an action that took place over a period of time in the past	She **worked** in this company from 2003 to 20
	3- To express a series of completed actions in the past:	1-I **woke** up, **got dressed**, and **had** breakfast. 2-She ***went*** to the shop, ***bought*** some milk, and ***came*** home.
	4- Past habits or repeated actions (that no longer happen): Often used with "used to."	1-I **played** football every Saturday when I **was** young. (I don't play football every Saturday now). 2-He **smoked** a lot before he **quit**. (He doesn't smoke now).
	5-Past states or situations	1-She **was** unhappy.

Tense	Main Use	Example
Structure		
Past Progressive/ Past Continuous **Often indicate use of the Past Continuous:** *while, when, as*, at (a specific time), all day/night/morning, during	1- to express an action that was in progress at some point or over period in the past	1- The train **was running** at full speed at that 2-They **were playing** football between 4 and
	2-To express two parallel cations which continued for some time in the past	While her mother **was knitting** a pullover, he
	3- To express a frequently repeated past action	1- The employees **were** always **complaining.**
	4-To express gradual development of an action	It **was getting** dark. The patient **was getting** restless.

Tense	Main Use	Example
Structure		
Past Perfect	1-It clarifies which event occurred first, establishing a clear sequence of past events. Also referred to as "the past before the past.	1-I had finished my work before I went to bed. (First I finished my work, then I went to bed). She had already eaten when I arrived. (She ate before I arrived.) 2-Before the war, he had worked as a bank manager.

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Tense	Main Use	Example
Structure		
Past Perfect	1-To express an action completed before a given moment in the past. This past moment may be indicated directly or by another past event Note-These words and phrases often indicate the use of the Past Perfect: *before, after, when, by the time, as soon as, until, already, just, never*	1-They **had finished** the interview by 11:30. 2- I **had switched off** the television before I went to sleep.

Tense	Main Use	Example
Structure		
Past Perfect Continuos	To emphasize the recentness and the duration of a continuous activity that took place before a particular time in the past, **past perfect progressive** is employed.	1-Until now the rumours that **had been circulating** were exaggerated versions of the truth. 2-He died in hospital where *he* **had been receiving** treatment for piles.

Tense	Main Use	Example
Structure		
Future Time Any reference to future events is expression of what might happen or what one intends to do.	1-Employed to express something is planned to happen, or is likely to happen in the future, use the modal *will* before the base form of the verb.	1-These **will** be dealt with in chapter 9. 2-I **will check**,' said Sharukh. 3-When **will** I **see** them?
	2-To talk about general truths and to say what can be expected to happen if a particular situation arises, you use *will*.	1-When peace is available, people **will go** for it.
	3- Indicating certainty: Used if sure that something will happen because arrangements have been made.	1-I**'ll be meeting** them when I've finished with you. 2-I**'ll be waiting** for you outside.
	4-If referring to something that has not happened yet, will happen before a particular time in the future.	1-By the time you get to the school, the concert **will have finished.** 2-Maybe by the time we get there he**'ll** already **have started**.
	5-To indicate the duration of an event at a specific time in the future	1-By the time the season ends, I **will have been playing** for fifteen months without a break. 2-The register **will have been running** for a year in May.

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Other ways of talking about the future

1) If stating an intention that something will happen, or if one has an immediate evidence that something will happen fairly soon, use be going to followed by an **infinitive**.

i. I'm going to explore the neighbourhood.

Evans knows lots of people.

ii. He's going to help me. He's going to take me there.

iii. You're going to have a heart attack if you're not careful.

2) The present simple is used to talk about timetabled or scheduled events.

i. My last train leaves Mathura at 10:00 pm.

ii. The UN General Assembly opens in New York later this month.

iii. Tomorrow morning we meet up to exchange contracts.

3) The present progressive is used to state firm plans for the future. A time marker is necessary unless one is sure that the hearer or reader knows that you are talking about the future.

i. I'm leaving at the end of this week.

ii. My mum is coming to help look after the new baby.

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Present Indefinite-Structure

'is', 'am', 'are' are forms of the verb used in the simple present tense. Their use depends on the subject of the sentence

1. **'is'** is used with 3PSg (third person singular) subject (he, she, it, or singular nouns).
Structure: *Subject + is + complement*
2. 'are' used with plural subjects (we, you, they, or plural nouns). Also used with 'you' (both singular and plural).
Structure: *Subject + are + complement*
3. 'am' used with the 1PSg (first-person singular) subject.
Structure: *I + am + complement*

Negative Forms- Add *not* after *is*, *am*, *are*.
Interrogative Forms- Place *is*, *am*, *are* before the subject.

The structure of Present Indefinite depends on the subject of the sentence.

Affirmative

- For *I, you, we, they* use the base form of the verb.
- For *he, she, it* add -s or -es to the base form of the verb.

Negative

do not/ don't or *does not/ doesn't* used before the base form of the verb.

I, you, we, they do not/don't + base form

He, she, it does not/doesn't + base form

Interrogative (Questions)

do or *does* used before the subject and the base form of the verb.
I, you, we, they: do + subject + base form?
*He, she, it: d*oes + subject + base form?

Present Continuous/Progressive- Structure

Employed to denote an action that is continue at the present moment.

Affirmative

"to be" + -ing form of the verb
Subject + am/is/are + verb-ing
You, We, They: You/We/They *are playing*.
He, She, It: He/She/ It *is reading*

Negative Form:

Add "not" after "is/am/are."
Subject + am/is/are + not + verb-ing
(Contractions: I'm not, she isn't, they aren't)

Interrogative Form (Questions):

Invert the subject and "am/is/are."
Am/Is/Are + subject + verb-ing?
Examples:Am I *working*? *Is* she *listening*? *Are* they *playing*?

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Stative Verbs

Stative verbs describe a state of affair/ being or condition.These don't take continuous form.

Examples:

Verbs of perception: see, hear, smell, taste, feel

Verbs of thought/opinion: think, believe, know, understand, remember, forget

Verbs of emotion: love, hate, like, dislike, want, need

Verbs of possession: have, own, belong

Other verbs: be, seem, appear, cost

Example: I *understand* the lesson. (Not: I am understanding).

*Some stative verbs can be used in the continuous form with a different meaning:

Example: I *think* it's a good idea (opinion). I *am thinking* about my holiday (process of thinking).

Present Perfect/ Present Perfect Progressive: This tense indicates that the verb's action began in the past and continued through the time the sentence is written. It is denoted by adding the past participle of the verb to the word 'have.'

Present perfect: "have/has" + past participle of the verb.

Subject + have/has + past participle

I, You, We, They: have + past participle (e.g., have eaten, have gone)

He, She, It: has + past participle (e.g., has eaten, has gone).

Present Perfect Continuous: Subject + have/has + been + verb-ing

I, You, We, They: have been + verb-ing (e.g., have been eating, have been going)

He, She, It: has been + verb-ing (e.g., has been eating, has been going)

Present Perfective Interrogative: Invert the subject and the auxiliary verb.

Have/has+ Subject+V3+(Object)

'Have you finished your homework?'

Negative forms: Subject + have/has + not + past participle

i. I *have not (haven't) eaten*.

Add "not" after "have/has."

Subject + have/has + not + been + verb-ing

i. I *have not (haven't) been eating for hours.*

ii. She *has not (hasn't) been going to club since January.*

iii. They *have not (haven't) been watching movie since morning.*

Contrast with Past Simple:

The main difference is:

Present Perfect: Focuses on the result or connection to the present. The time is not specified or not important.

Past Simple: Focuses on a completed action at a specific time in the past.

Example: I *have seen* that movie (I have the experience of seeing it)./ I *saw* that movie last week (The time is specified).

Past Simple

Past Simple is used to describe completed actions or events that happened at a specific time in the past. Employed essential for narrating stories, describing past experiences, and talking about historical events.

Structure

Structure of the Past Simple depends on whether the verb is regular or irregular.

Regular Verbs: Add "-ed" to the base form of the verb.

Examples: work - worked, play - played, study - studied, walk – walked

Irregular Verbs: Have different forms that need to be memorized. There is no consistent rule.

Examples: go - went, eat - ate, see - saw, come - came, be - was/were

Negative Form

Use "did not" (didn't) + the base form of the verb.

Subject + did not (didn't) + base form

i. I *didn't go* to the party.

ii. She *didn't study* math.

iii. They *didn't live* in Paris.

Interrogative Form

Use "did" before the subject and the base form of the verb.

Did + subject + base form

i. Did you *go* to the party?

ii. Did she *study* math?

iii. Did they *live* in Paris?

Past Continuous/ Progressive: (past continuous) is a past tense verb form used for actions that were ongoing in the past.

Key Time Expressions:

Often indicate use of the Past Continuous:

while, when, as, at (a specific time), all day/night/morning, during

Contrast with Past Simple:

The key difference is the focus:

Past Continuous: Focuses on the *ongoing nature* of an action in the past.

Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
I was walking	I wasn't walking	Was I walking?
You were walking (singular)	You weren't walking (singular)	Were you walking? (singular)
He/she/it was walking	He/she/it wasn't walking	Was he/she/it walking?

Past Simple: Focuses on a *completed action* at a specific time in the past.

Structure

Subject + was/were + verb-ing

I, He, She, It: was + verb-ing (e.g., was eating, was going)

You, We, They: were + verb-ing (e.g., were eating, were going)

Past Perfect and Past Perfect Progressive

Structure

Past Perfect: **Subject + had + past participle**

Examples: I *had eaten*. She *had gone*. They *had seen*.

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Past Perfect Progressive: **"had" + been + present participle (-ing)**

Expressing Future Time

Will and shall

	Main Use	Example
Present Simple	Routine, facts, universal truths	She works as a teacher.
Present Continuous	Actions in progress, temporary situations	I am writing a letter.
Present Perfect	Past actions with present relevance	He has finished his homework.
Present Perfect Continuous	Emphasis on duration of ongoing action	She has been reading for hours.
Past Simple	Completed actions in the past	They visited Paris last summer.
Past Continuous	Actions in progress in the past	I was watching TV when the phone rang.
Past Perfect	Actions completed before another past action	She had left before I arrived.
Past Perfect Continuous	Duration of a past action before another past event	They had been studying all night.
Future Simple	Plans, predictions, promises	We will go to the park tomorrow.
Future Continuous	Actions in progress at a future time	This time tomorrow, I will be flying.
Future Perfect	Actions completed by a future time	He will have finished by next week.
Future Perfect Continuous	Duration of actions up to a future point	She will have been waiting for hours.

Summary

References

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